

Baylor Eswatini_Eswatini_2025-26_3-Month Report

Fellowship Organization

Baylor Eswatini

Fellowship City

Mbabane

Fellowship Country

Eswatini

Fellowship Start Date

8/11/2025

Anticipated End Date

8/11/2026

What kind of visa/ permit do you have or applied for?

Baylor Foundation Eswatini managed the visa application process and obtained a one-year work visa

How did you obtain (or are obtaining) your visa or permit?

Baylor emailed a list of documents that needed to be completed (health screening, passport, background check, etc) and sent and they handled the rest.

Did you apply for and receive your visa or permit before going to your host country or after arriving?

I was not allowed to enter the country until the visa was approved, which caused issues with our start date. The application process in Eswatini took several months (May-Aug)

What costs were associated with obtaining your visa or permit?

The background check was around \$80 USD. The visa application itself costs money, but this was covered by Baylor, so I am not sure how much it was.

Did you pay the visa / permit costs or were they covered by your organization?

I paid for the background check, and Baylor paid the application fees

Are you still having challenges obtaining your visa/ permit?

Yes

If yes, please explain further

As mentioned, the visa process took an extremely long time; my cofellow and I both turned in our applications in early May and did not get approved until mid-August. We were not allowed to enter Eswatini until the visa was approved, so we both worked remotely from the US for about a week and a half due to PiAf's start date window. Now that we have our visas, we don't have to do any type of renewals during the year because they are year-long visas, which is great, but getting them in the first place was really difficult.

Do you have any suggestions to help future Fellows navigate the visa / permit application process?

Turn in everything that is asked of you as early as possible. The government systems of approval are reallyyyy slow, and there is nothing that can be done to speed them up. Be sure to get everything notarized correctly and have everything in the right format--they are very particular about that. The background check that they are looking for is fingerprint-based and can be done at most UPS stores--it is not the kind they can print out for \$20 at your local police station (I turned in the wrong one the first time).

What vaccinations were you required to obtain prior to your departure?

How was your arrival and first week in your host country?